HACK4CHANGE

Smarter Giving. Stronger Community.

March 13–15, 2026 | Venn Innovation, Moncton

Civic Tech Moncton | GMHSC | United Way | Venn Innovation

“You’re here because you give a damn.”

This is not a typical hackathon.
The solution you build this weekend gets deployed.
Real organizations. Real people. Real stakes.

COMMUNITY CONTEXT

Greater Moncton Homelessness Steering Committee

~550

people experiencing Chronic Homelessness in Greater Moncton

VISION

Ending homelessness in Greater Moncton by uniting communities, government, and resources to provide immediate access to safe housing and life-changing support for all.

MISSION

Committed to ending homelessness by addressing its root causes through person-centered, data-informed strategies. By leveraging Coordinated Access and fostering cross-sector collaboration, we connect vulnerable individuals with the housing and services they need to thrive.

MANDATE

We lead a data-driven, person-first approach to end chronic homelessness and ensure equitable access to housing and services. By strengthening partnerships and using data, we drive lasting change, challenging stigma, and working toward a future where homelessness is rare, brief, and non-recurring.

COMMUNITY CONTEXT

The GMHSC Network

28
organizations

- Ability NB
- Alternative Residence Inc.
- Beauséjour Community Mental Health Centre
- City of Moncton
- Crossroads for Women Inc.
- Ensemble Greater Moncton
- Harvest House Atlantic
- Horizon Health – Mental Health and Addictions
- House of Nazareth
- Housing, Infrastructure and Communities Canada
- Housing NB
- Human Development Council
- Humanity Project
- John Howard Society of Southeastern NB
- PEAR
- RCMP-Community Police
- Rising Tide
- Salvus
- Shelter Movers
- Social Développement/Southeast Zone
- South East Regional Service Commission
- Town of Riverview
- United Way of Greater Moncton and SENB
- Ville de Dieppe
- Vitalité – Public Health and Mental Health
- YMCA Greater Moncton (Community Outreach)
- Youth Impact Jeunesse Inc.
- YWCA Moncton

28 member organizations · 60+ total members

It can be difficult to see the full picture".
"It can be difficult to see the full picture".

CHALLENGE REVEAL

The Community Coordination Challenge

Shelters and other community organizations across the GMHSC network are texting and emailing each other to coordinate donations.

Some are overstocked. Others are understocked. It can be difficult to see the full picture.

There is no shared system. You are building it.

THE BRIEF

Who You're Building For

PRIMARY USERS

Donors

Individuals or organizations contributing goods or resources to support community programs.

GMHSC Organizations

Frontline staff responsible for receiving, managing, and distributing donated items.

Program Coordinators

People overseeing activities across multiple shelters or community organizations.

OPERATIONAL NEEDS

- Improving visibility of available resources
- Helping organizations coordinate donations
- Identifying urgent needs across GMHSC organizations
- Reducing waste or duplication of donated items
- Making donation processes easier for contributors

THE BRIEF

Real-World Design Constraints

Solutions that emphasize simplicity, usability, and practicality will perform well.

Limited Tech Literacy

Users may have limited technical expertise. Design for the least tech-savvy person on the team.

Staff Time is Precious

Workflows must be simple. If it takes too long to learn or use, it won't be used.

Imperfect Data

Data may be incomplete or inconsistent. Your system needs to handle the real-world mess.

Multiple Organizations

Multiple independent organizations may need to use the same system at the same time.

THE BRIEF

What You Need to Deliver

DELIVERABLES

- GitHub repository link containing your project
- README explaining the solution and how it works
- Team information included
- Short demo or walkthrough during judging

SUBMISSION DEADLINE

Sunday — 12:00 PM

Late submissions cannot be accepted.

JUDGING CRITERIA

Impact: Usefulness to shelters, coordinators, and donors

Feasibility: Whether the concept could realistically be implemented

Innovation: Creativity and originality of approach

Technical Design: Code structure, architecture, and soundness

UX: Intuitive and usable for non-technical users

Pitch Quality: Clarity and effectiveness of the final presentation

TECHNICAL SETUP

GitHub & Toolkit

GitHub repo link will be posted in Slack at kickoff

What's in the repo: sample datasets · starter kit · API schema sketch · README

Fork the Starter Kit

Use the provided boilerplate. Good if you want to move fast.

Build from Scratch

Any language. Any stack. Document everything in your README.

README has everything. Direct questions to Slack. The repo is flexible — adjust as needed through the weekend.

GROUND RULES

How This Works

All work starts tonight — No pre-built submissions. Everything must begin at kickoff. Judges will know.

AI tools are welcome — Use them freely. Just declare everything in your README. Transparency is the only rule.

Open source is your friend — Libraries, frameworks, starter kits — all allowed. Document what you use.

Submit by Sunday 12:00 PM — GitHub repo + short form. Late submissions cannot be accepted.

Be excellent to each other — Code of Conduct applies. This is a community event.

The Prizes

1ST PLACE

$2,000

Sponsored by

CCNB

2ND PLACE

$1,000

Sponsored by

City of Moncton

BEST PITCH

$500

Sponsored by

Civic Tech Moncton

Winners announced Sunday — approximately 3:30 PM

COMMUNICATIONS

Everything Lives in Slack

"If it is not in Slack, it does not exist."

You should already be in the channel. Check your invite.

GitHub Link

Repo posted at kickoff

Mentor Schedule

Who's available and when

Announcements

All updates all weekend

Judging Updates

Criteria, order, timing

#q-and-a

Ask anything, anytime

SUPPORT AVAILABLE

Mentorship & Support

SATURDAY · MARCH 14

8:00 AM – 12:00 PM

1:30 PM – 5:30 PM

Morning and afternoon blocks

SUNDAY · MARCH 15

8:00 AM – 12:00 PM

Code freeze support only

Full mentor schedule is pinned in Slack · GMHSC liaisons available for domain and user questions

THE PLAN

Weekend at a Glance

FRIDAY

- Challenge reveal — tonight
- Team formation: 7:00 PM
- Hacking starts tonight

SATURDAY

- Build all day
- Mentors: 8 AM–12 PM, 1:30–5:30 PM
- Pitch workshop: 6:30 PM

SUNDAY

- Final sprint
- Submit by 12:00 PM
- Demos + judging: 1:00 PM
- Awards: ~3:30 PM

7:00 PM

Team Formation Starts Now

- Maximum 4 people per team
- Already have a team? Register together tonight.
- Going solo? We will match you.
- Eugene G. will walk you through the process.

“Go build something that matters.”

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